

AKASH BASNET

Ethical Hacker & Bug Bounty Hunter | Penetration Testing | Web Application & API Security

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SUMMARY

Certified Ethical Hacker and bug bounty hunter who has helped secure 25+ organizations, including **Google, Apple, Meta, Microsoft, McAfee, ESET, Harvard, Cambridge, Intel, Lenovo** and **BBC News**. First place at the Pacific Hackers Pre-DEF CON CTF; invited and sponsored to DEF CON twice and Black Hat USA once. Six years running IT infrastructure, including leading a government ministry through a live ransomware attack.

SECURITY RESEARCH & RECOGNITION

- 2022** Google Stored XSS and further issues across Googleplex, Waze and internal assets. \$5,000+ in bounties and a Hall of Fame listing.
- 2021** Meta, ESET Messenger vulnerability: \$750 bounty and a whitehat Hall of Fame place. Letter of thanks from the ESET CISO.
- 2020** Apple, Microsoft, BBC News, Huawei filemaker.com vulnerability in Apple's security credits; reflected XSS on a Microsoft acquisition in MSRC acknowledgements; rate-limit bypass listed first on BBC News 2020; Huawei PSIRT letter.
- 2019** Harvard, Cambridge, Intel, McAfee Letters from the Harvard CISO and Cambridge CSIRT; Intel certificate of appreciation; McAfee certificate signed by the CISO.
- 2018** Lenovo Letter of acknowledgement from Lenovo PSIRT.

Competitions 1st place, Pre-DEF CON CTF (Pacific Hackers Association, HackerDojo) · Top 50 of 500, Wiz CTF · Top 500 of 5,000, U.S. DoD CTF · DEF CON x2 and Black Hat USA x1, invited and sponsored.

Press Three features in Tech Pana, plus Capital Nepal, The Annapurna Express and Gorkhapatra.

EXPERIENCE

Bug Bounty Hunter

2026 – Present

Bugcrowd · Remote

- Test web applications and APIs on public and private programs, including NASA's VDP, for XSS, SSRF, SQL injection, IDOR and broken access control.
- Map attack surface through recon and subdomain enumeration, confirm findings in Burp Suite, and write reproducible reports with remediation guidance.

Technical Support Analyst (Internship)

2026

NVIDIA · Santa Clara, CA

- Resolved account lockouts, MFA and passkey resets, and Conditional Access failures in Entra ID and Active Directory.
- Reimaged Windows, macOS and Linux endpoints, enrolled them in Intune and Jamf Pro, and ran security baseline and QA checks before deployment.
- Primary walk-in analyst at the Tech Lounge, troubleshooting GlobalProtect VPN, Wi-Fi and software access for a globally distributed workforce.

Customer Service Specialist

2024 – Present

Radiate Hospitality · Palo Alto, CA

- Handle front desk guest requests and escalations, and prepare shift reports for guests and staff.

IT Manager

2021 – 2022

Ministry of Law, Justice & Parliamentary Affairs · Kathmandu, Nepal

- Led containment of a live ransomware attack, isolating affected endpoints and recovering data with no permanent loss.
- Provided cybersecurity support to federal offices at Singha Durbar, including the Office of the Prime Minister.
- Enforced security policies, access controls, backups and patching across servers, Cisco and Fortinet networks, and Microsoft 365.

IT Manager

2016 – 2021

Global Link Technologies Ltd. · Kathmandu, Nepal

- Rolled out endpoint security baselines, a patch cadence and access controls across 50+ devices, reducing incidents and downtime.
- Saved \$25,000+ a year by bringing IT support in-house and renegotiating vendor contracts and licensing.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Offensive Security** Penetration testing, bug bounty research, vulnerability assessment, OWASP Top 10, MITRE ATT&CK, XSS, SSRF, SQLi, IDOR, recon and subdomain enumeration, responsible disclosure.
- SOC & Defense** SIEM, alert triage, threat hunting, log analysis, IDS and IPS, incident response, malware analysis, phishing triage, EDR, zero trust.
- Enterprise IT** Entra ID, Active Directory, MFA and SSO, Conditional Access, Intune, Jamf Pro, endpoint hardening, patch management, Fortinet, GlobalProtect VPN, Cisco, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Google Cloud.
- Tools** Burp Suite, Kali Linux, Wireshark, Python, Bash, Git and GitHub, ServiceNow, Jira.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

In progress OSCP (OffSec PEN-200) · Burp Suite Certified Practitioner (PortSwigger)

CEH, EC-Council 2019 · Fortinet Network Security 2024 · Google Cloud Cybersecurity 2025 · Google IT Support Professional 2025 · Microsoft IT Support Specialist 2025 · Claude 101 and AI Fluency, Anthropic 2026

BBS, Tribhuvan University, The Times International College 2019 · **BCA** (first semester), Tribhuvan University, Nepal Mega College 2022 · **IT Support Training**, Year Up United 2025